

UDISE+ 2024-25

**A Snapshot of India's
Evolving School
Education Landscape**

05 December 2024



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INTRODUCTION

The state of a nation's education system is a transparent mirror of its progress and potential. With over 25 crore school-going children, India's education system is among the largest and most diverse globally.¹ After years of anticipation, fresh data from the Unified District Information System (UDISE+) is finally available, providing a much-needed glimpse into the schooling trends across the country.²

The new figures, released in October 2024, break a two-year data drought and highlight key trends. However, as the data trickles in, the complete picture still evolves. This data doesn't just reflect numbers; it tells a compelling story of systemic challenges that demand attention and action.

This abstract examines the key trends highlighted in the UDISE+ report up to 2024-25, specifically examining the trend in the number of schools and student enrolment data over multiple years.³

By leveraging this detailed data and trends, policymakers and education sector stakeholders can better understand regional disparities, track progress, and ensure that the evolving education landscape remains inclusive and accessible.

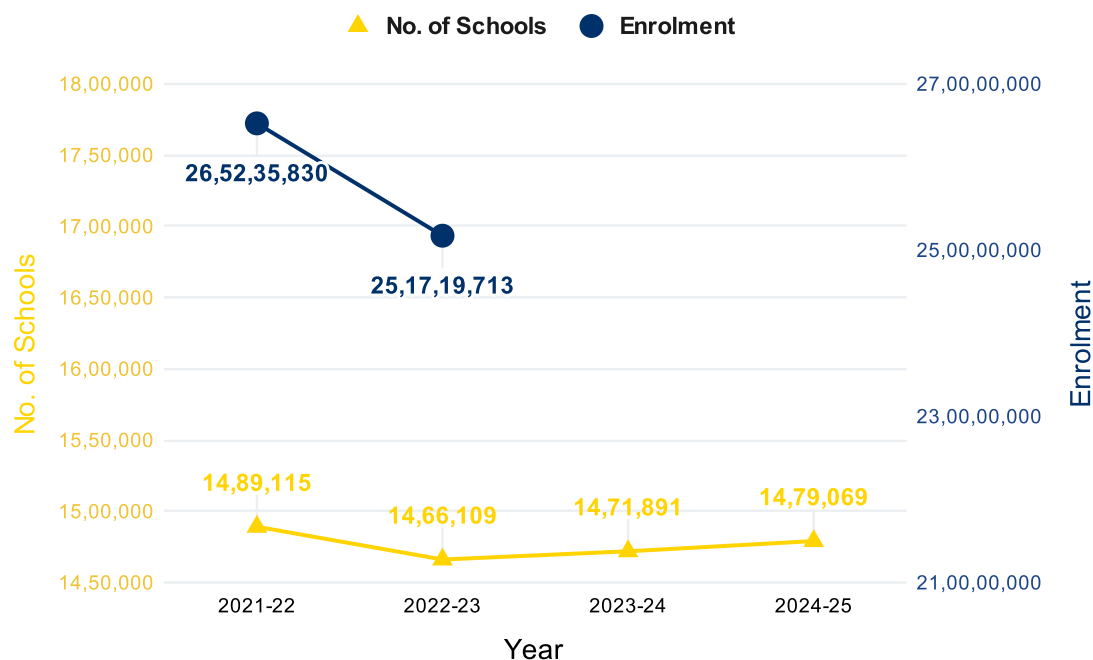
¹ Total Enrolment Trends in India from 2019-20 to 2022-23, <https://kys.udiseplus.gov.in/#/region>

² The last data was released in 2021-22. Until 2021-22, UDISE used to release school-wise (anonymised) micro-data in a CSV format that allowed detailed analysis. As of now, data for 2022-23 is not yet available in the broader format. <https://dashboard.udiseplus.gov.in/#/home>

³ This report focuses on the key trends highlighted in the UDISE Report 2024, specifically examining the growth in the number of schools over multiple years (2021-22 to 2024-25) and student enrolment data for 2021-22 to 2022-23, as available on December 5, 2024, and is subject to change as new information becomes available. <https://kys.udiseplus.gov.in/#/home>

OVERALL TRENDS IN NUMBER OF SCHOOLS AND ENROLMENT

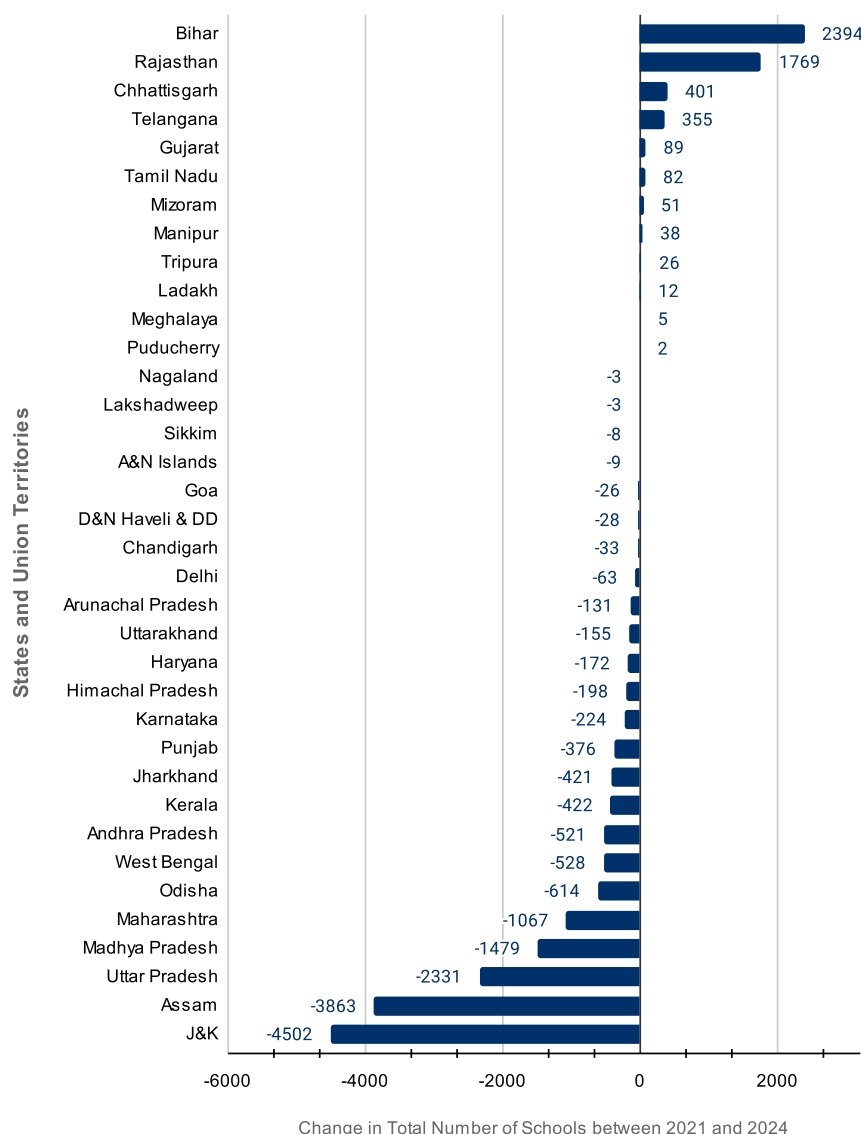
Figure 1: Year-wise national trends in the number of schools (2021 – 2024) and enrolment (2021 -2022)



The country saw a net reduction of 10,046 schools from 2021-22 to 2024-25, representing a 0.67% decline. Student enrolment trends mirror this decline by 5%—meaning a staggering 1.3 crore fewer students in the system! But beneath these changes lies a more nuanced story of structural transformation that varies dramatically by region and school type.

STATE/UT TRENDS IN NUMBER OF SCHOOLS BY MANAGEMENT

Figure 2: Change in the total number of schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs



Two-third of the states and UTs have experienced a decline in the number of schools. The largest declines are seen in Jammu and Kashmir (-4,502 schools, a 16% decrease), Assam (-3,863 schools, a 6% decline), Uttar Pradesh (-2331 schools, a 0.9% reduction) and other states. Bihar and Rajasthan bucked this national trend of school declines, with Bihar adding 2,394 schools, reflecting a 3% increase, and Rajasthan adding 1,769 schools, or 2%.

UDISE+ classifies schools into four management types: Government, Government-Aided, Private Unaided, and Other schools.⁴ The following provides an overview of how the numbers across these categories evolved over the past four years.

Figure 3: The overall numbers are presented for each of the four management types. An index has been created to visualise the trend, with the number of schools set to 100.0 in 2021-22 for each category

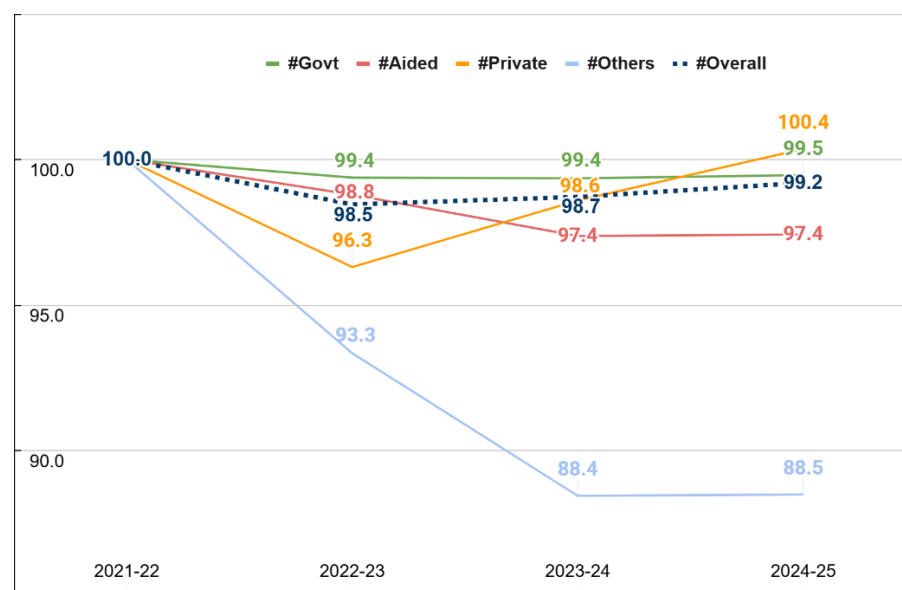
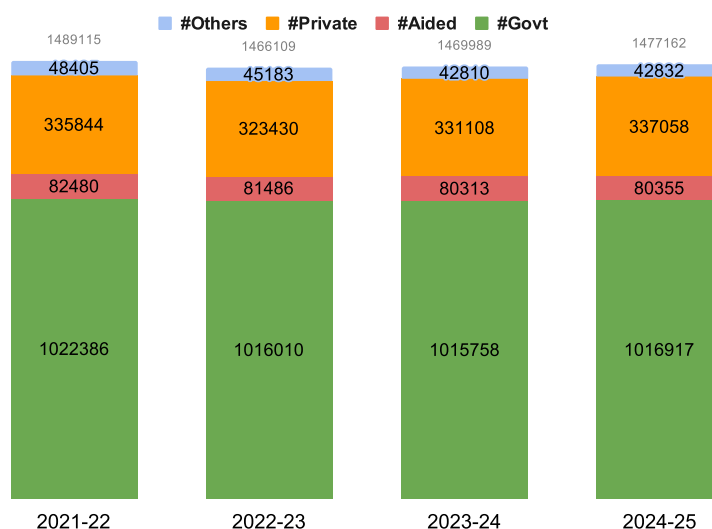


Figure 4: Overall Management-wise number of schools from 2021 to 2024



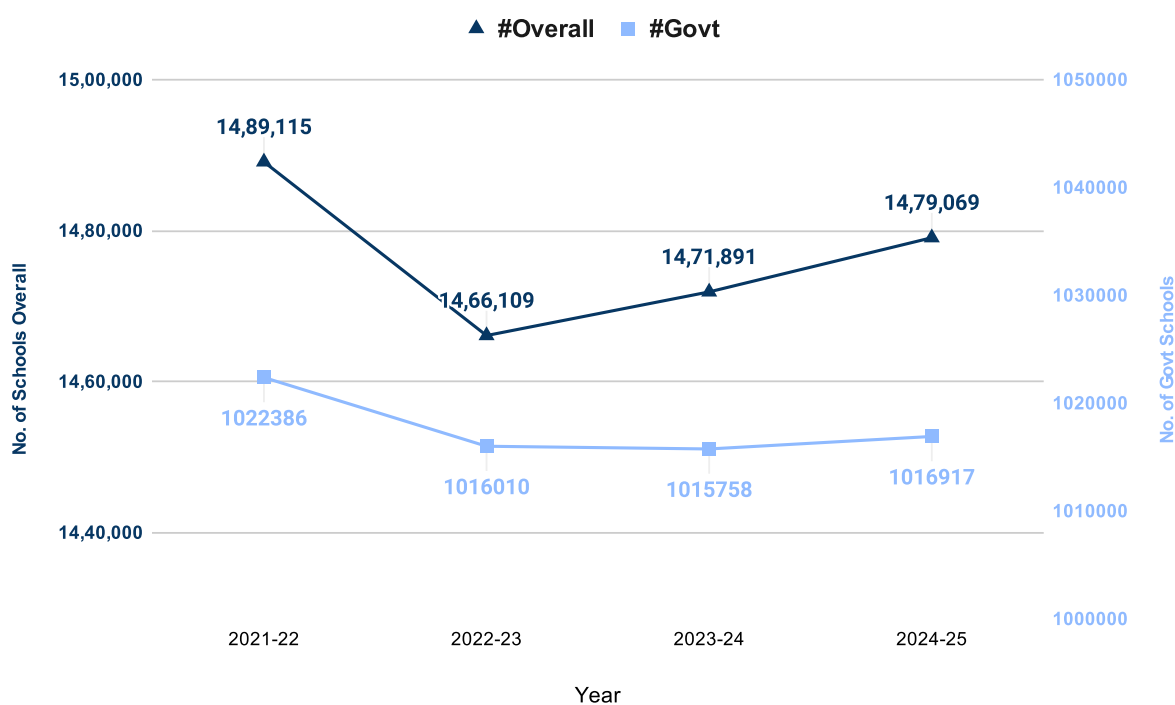
⁴ *"Other schools" refers to madrasas (recognised and unrecognised) and other unrecognised schools, as assumed based on the distribution in previous UDISE data, where such a breakdown was provided. The current data does not offer this specific breakdown, but the assumption remains based on historical trends till 2021-22. <https://dashboard.udiseplus.gov.in/#/home>

The data reveals several key trends across different school management types over the past four years.

- Government schools have declined, reflecting the broader national trend of reduced educational institutions.
- Similarly, schools categorised under "Others", which include Madrasas and unrecognised schools, have experienced a significant decrease of 12%, totalling a loss of 5,573 schools.
- Government-aided schools have also followed a downward trajectory, contributing to the overall decline in the educational sector.
- In contrast, private unaided schools are the only management type that has grown, indicating a shift toward private education in some regions.

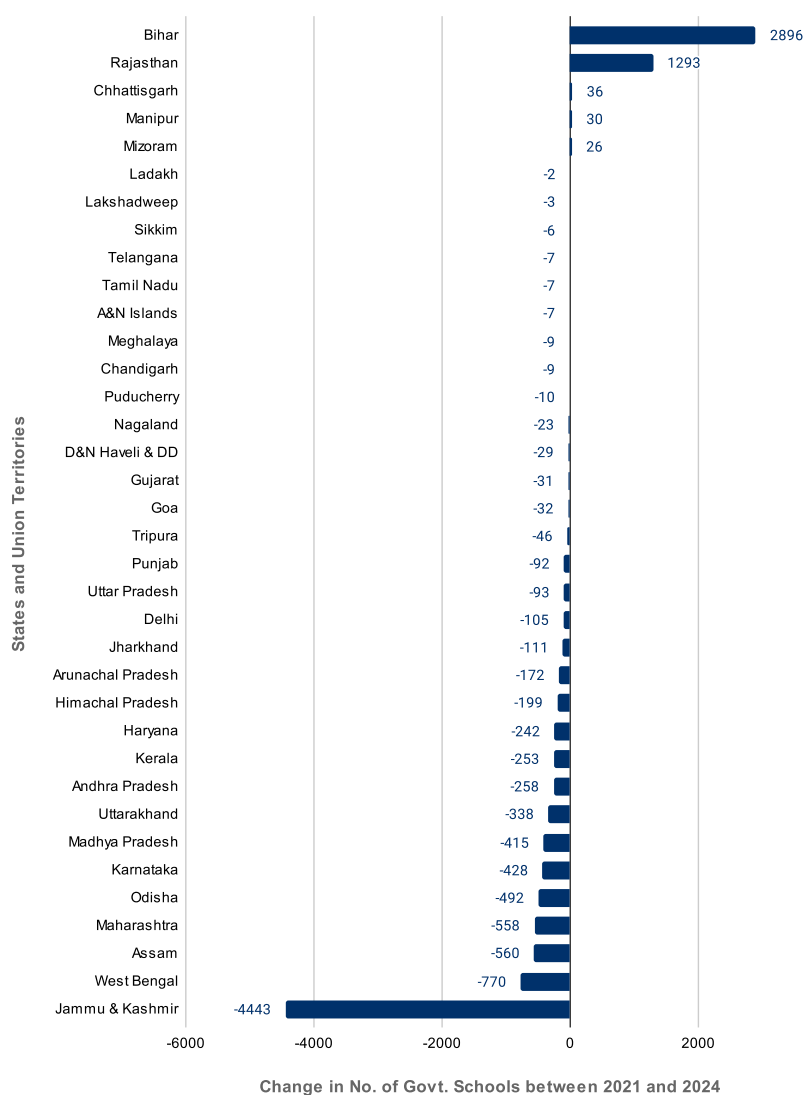
A. State/UT Trends: Government Schools

Figure 5: Year-wise trends of the number of overall schools and government schools in India between 2021 to 2024



Government schools, which have experienced a 0.53% decline at the national level, have mirrored the overall downward trend.

Figure 6: Change in the number of government schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs

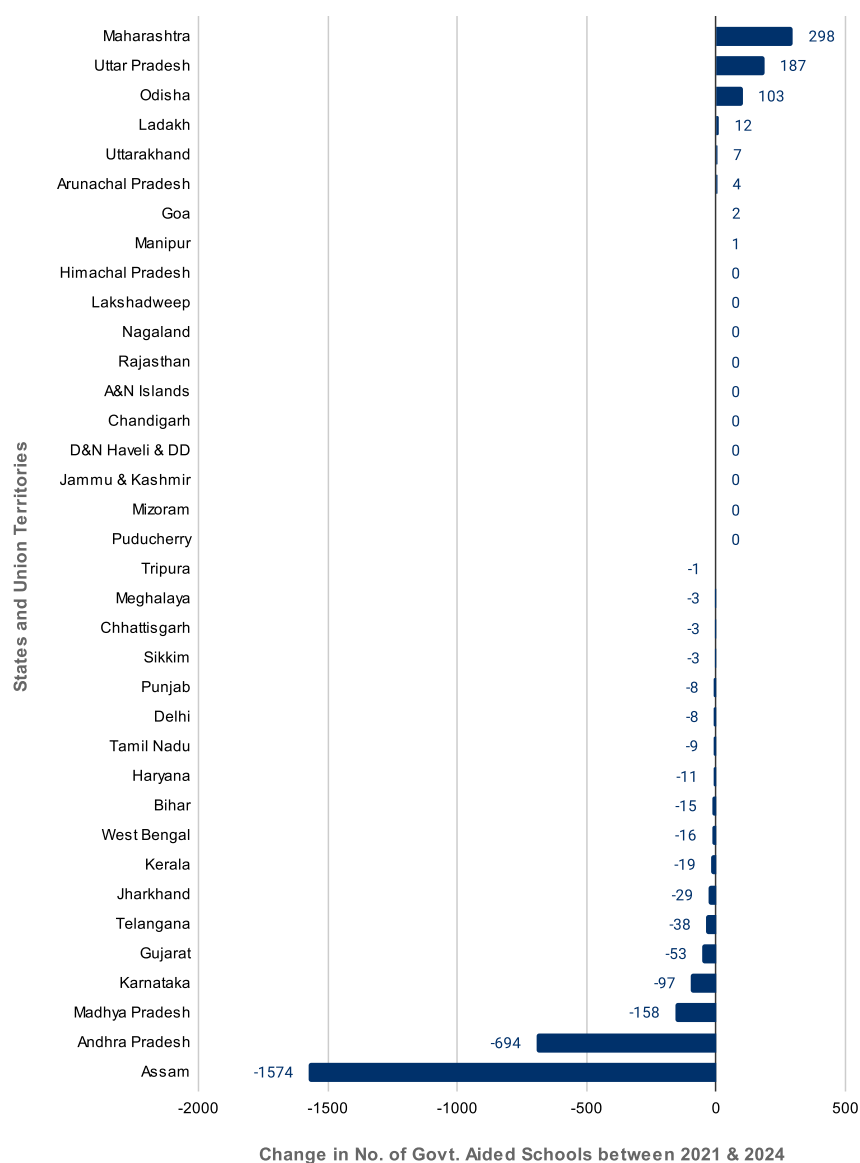


Out of 36 states and UTs, 31 have seen a decline in the number of government schools. The total reduction in government schools is most pronounced in Jammu and Kashmir, which lost 4,443 government schools, accounting for nearly all of the region's 4,502 net reduction in schools. Other states such as West Bengal (-770 schools), Assam (-560 schools), and Maharashtra (-558 schools) have also seen reductions in their government schools.

However, some states have bucked this trend. Bihar, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Manipur, and Mizoram have seen increases in government schools. For instance, Bihar added 2,896 government schools, contributing to its net increase of 2,394 schools overall. Similarly, Rajasthan saw a gain of 1,769 schools, driven primarily by adding 1,293 government schools.

B. State/UT Trends: Government Aided Schools

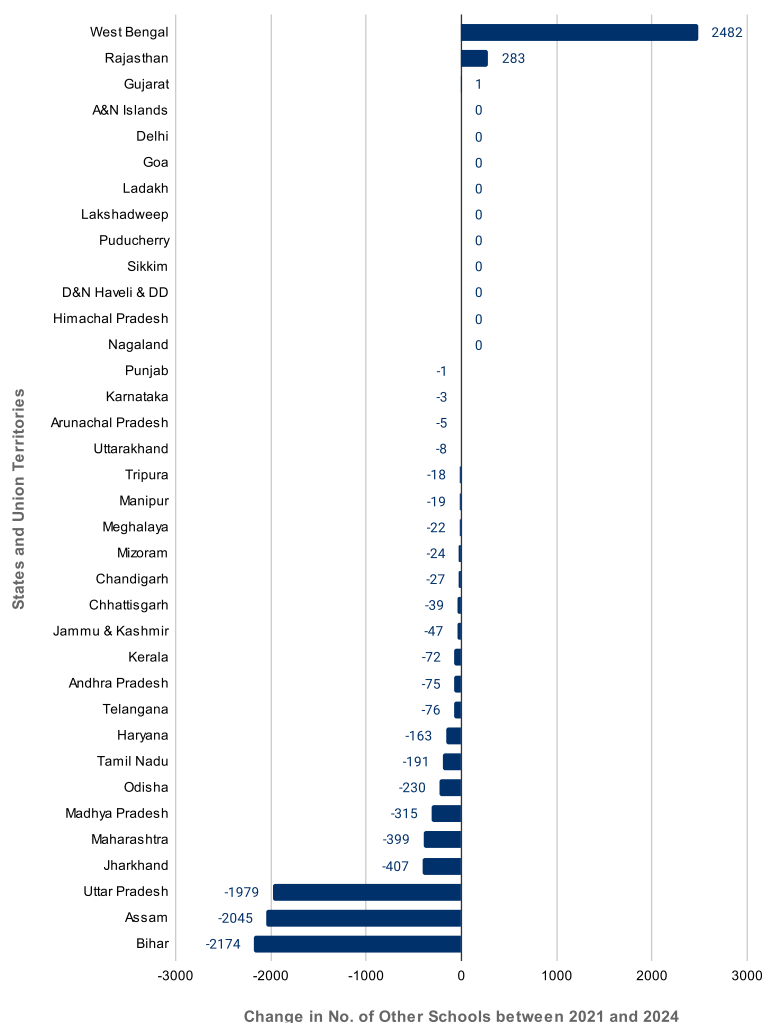
Figure 7: Change in the number of government-aided schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs



Government-aided schools have experienced a noticeable decline across India. Assam and Andhra Pradesh have seen substantial losses, with Assam losing 1,574 schools (around 41%) and Andhra Pradesh shedding 694 schools (around 45%). However, Ladakh saw an increase in government-aided schools, growing by 43%, adding 12 schools to its total. These trends highlight an impact on government-aided institutions, with some states facing sharp reductions while others, like Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, have seen growth.

C. State/UT Trends: Other Schools⁵

Figure 8: Change in the number of other schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs



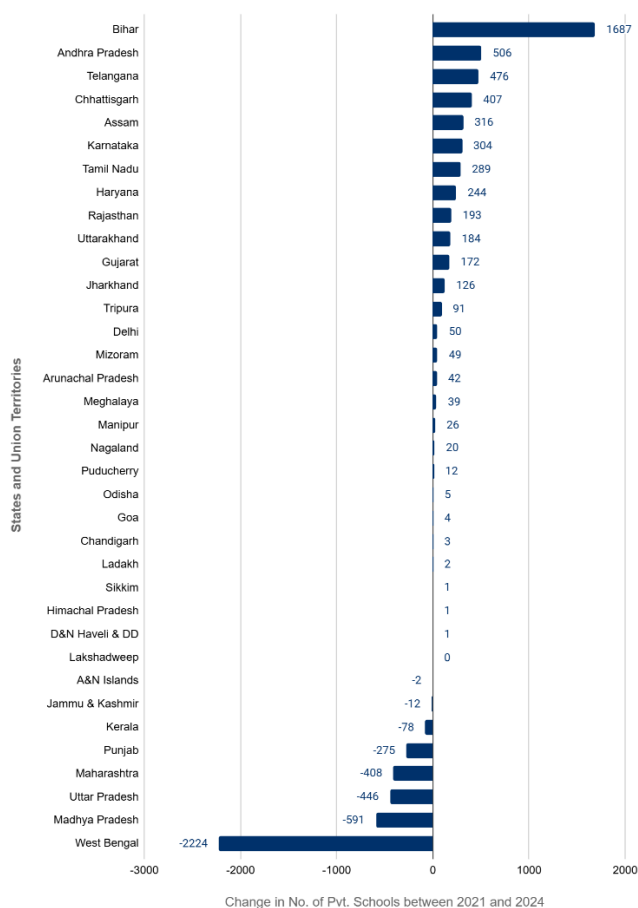
Other schools in India have experienced a significant decline of 12% (5,573 schools). Maharashtra has experienced the steepest reduction, with a 60% drop, marking a sharp decline, which is more than half of its Other schools. Large declines have been observed in Bihar (2,174 schools, a 25% drop), Assam (2,045 schools, a 36% drop), and Uttar Pradesh (1,979 schools, a 13% drop). This decrease is seen across all states and union territories, with the exceptions of Rajasthan, Gujarat, and West Bengal. Notably, West Bengal has recorded a remarkable increase of 155%, becoming two and a half times of the previous figure, adding 2,842 schools.

⁵ *"Other schools" refers to madrasas (both recognised and unrecognised) and other unrecognised schools, as assumed based on the distribution in previous UDISE data, where such a breakdown was provided. The current data does not offer this specific breakdown, but the assumption remains based on historical trends till 2021-22. <https://dashboard.udiseplus.gov.in/#/home>

D. State/UT Trends: Private Schools

The private sector's trend is evident nationwide. While government schools, aided institutions, and other schools have seen declines of 0.53%, 2.58%, and 11.51% respectively, private schools have grown by 0.36%.

Figure 9: Change in the number of government schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs



In 27 out of 36 states/UTs, the number of private schools has increased. Tripura and Bihar saw the highest percentage growth, with Tripura adding 91 schools (25%) and Bihar adding 1,687 schools (21%). Other states like Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, and Assam also experienced growth. However, West Bengal reported a decline of 2,224 private schools, a 23% reduction.

In 2021-22, private schools in West Bengal made up about 10% of all schools. By 2024-25, this share had further decreased to 8%. In contrast, the national share of private schools rose slightly, from 22.6% to 22.8%. Similar, though smaller, declines in private schools were seen in Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Punjab.

State/UT TRENDS IN NUMBER OF SCHOOLS BY LEVELS OF EDUCATION

Figure 10: Level of Education-wise Number of schools in 2024-25

● #primary ● #upper primary ● #secondary ● #higher secondary

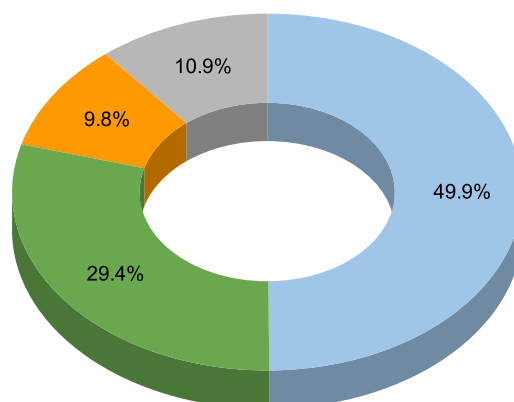
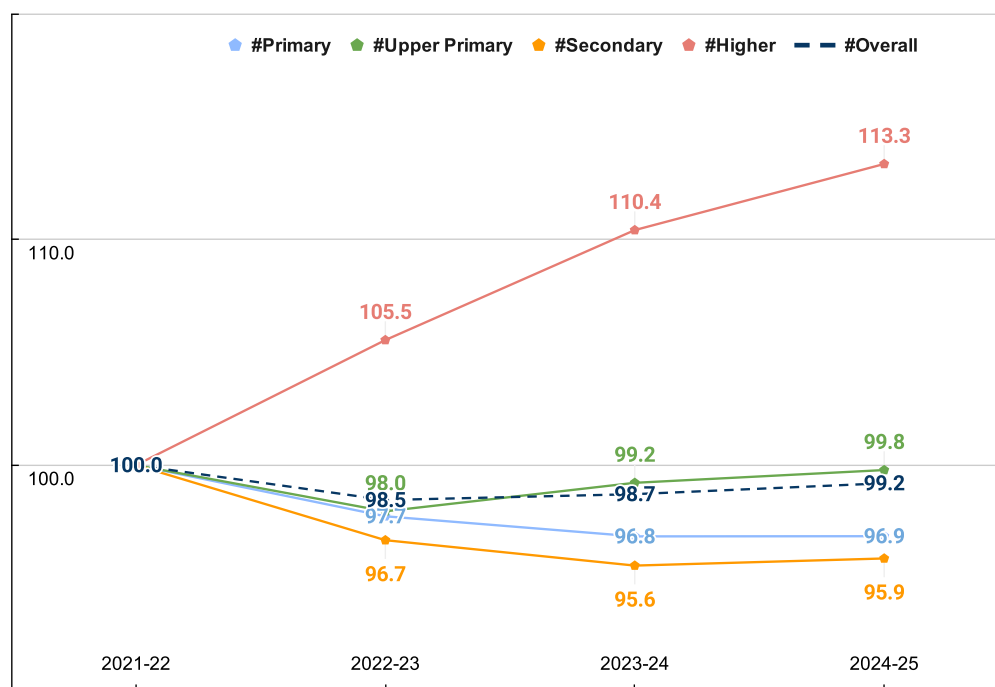


Figure 11: The overall numbers are presented for each of the levels of education. An index has been created to visualise the trend, with the number of schools set to 100.0 in 2021-22 for each category

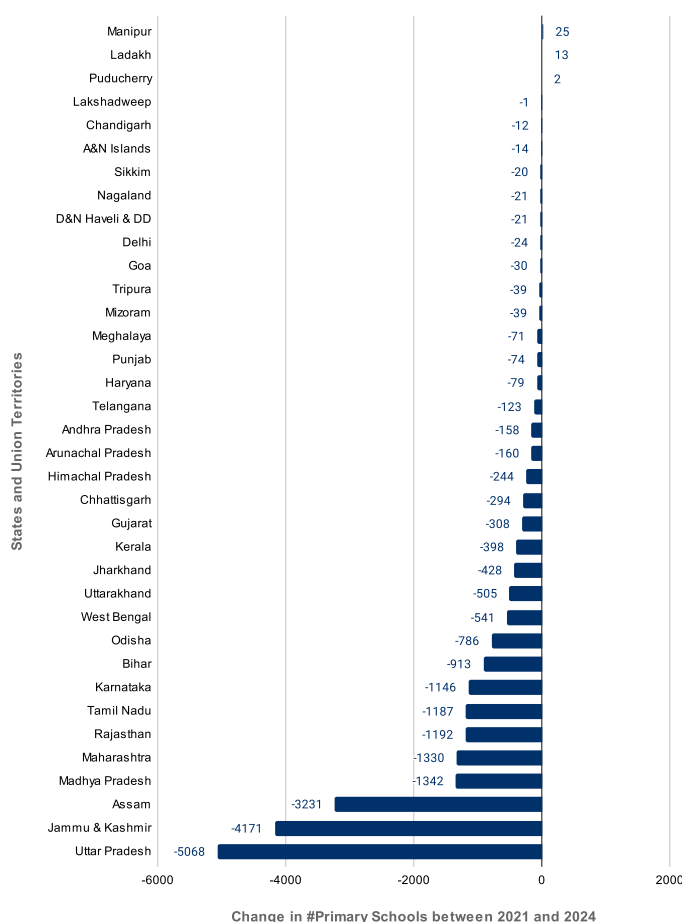


Primary schools, which make up half of all schools in India, saw a decline of 3%, losing 23,927 schools. Upper primary schools too saw a decline of 0.22%. In contrast, higher secondary schools experienced a significant increase, growing by 18,998 schools, or around

13%, indicating a positive trend of more schools offering grades 11 and 12 to complete the full schooling journey. However, the secondary schools witnessed a decline, which could be attributed to their transition into higher secondary schools, as many institutions could have expanded their offerings to include the upper grades.⁶

A. State/UT Trends: Primary Schools

Figure 12: Change in the number of primary schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs



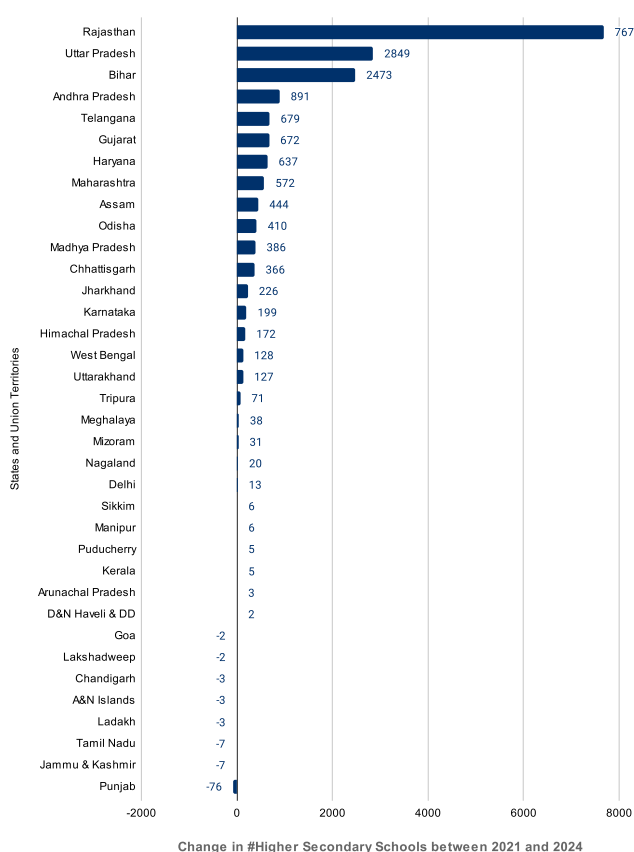
The story becomes more complex when examining education levels state-wise. Assam has a high percentage of primary schools, which is 66% as against 50% nationally. Additionally, West Bengal has a higher proportion of primary schools — 79%, well above the national average of 51% too. This reflects the need for expanding access to upper primary, secondary, and higher education, which will help ensure that students in the state have

⁶ UDISE+ categorises a school into a level of education based on the *highest* grade taught. For example, if the highest grade taught is 9th or 10th, the school is classified as a secondary school, regardless of the grades offered below that level.
<https://dashboard.udiseplus.gov.in/#/home>

more opportunities for continued learning beyond the primary level. While in numbers, the primary schools have seen the steepest decline nationally, with 23,927 fewer institutions—a 3% drop. The sharpest contraction occurred in Jammu & Kashmir, which lost 4,171 schools, a 28% decline. Some of the largest declines have been in Uttar Pradesh (5,068 schools, a 4% decline), Assam (3,231 schools, a 8% decline), Madhya Pradesh (1,342 schools, a 2% decline), Maharashtra (1,330 schools, a 3% decline), Rajasthan (1,192 schools, a 3% decline), Tamil Nadu (1,187 schools, a 3% decline), and Karnataka (1,146 schools, a 5% decline). There is an increase in the number of primary schools in just three comparatively lesser populated States/UTs: Manipur (+25), Ladakh (+13), and Pondicherry (+2).

B. State/UT Trends: Higher Secondary Schools

Figure 13: Change in the number of higher secondary schools between 2021 and 2024 across States and UTs



The country saw the addition of 18,998 higher secondary schools, reflecting a strong 13% increase. The increase is seen across 28 out of 36 states and union territories. Rajasthan led the way with an impressive 37% growth, adding 7,670 schools—accounting for about 40%

of the nationally added 18,998 higher secondary schools. This underscores Rajasthan's pivotal role in expanding educational infrastructure at this level and creating avenues for students who wish to complete their 12th grade. Uttar Pradesh followed, contributing 2,849 schools (a 14% increase), while Bihar added 2,473 schools, marking a notable 29% rise, alongside other states.

In Delhi, higher secondary schools are 23%, above the national average of 10%. While in Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, and Jharkhand the number of higher secondary schools is very less, as their figures fall short of the national average of 10%, with the most deficits - 7%, - 7%, and -6%, respectively.

TRENDS IN ENROLMENT BY MANAGEMENT

Of the 1.35 crore learners who slipped out of the schooling system, 1.14 crore (~85%) were in the government schools.

State/UT	Change in TOTAL	% Change in TOTAL	Change in OTHERS ⁷	% Change in OTHERS	Change in Govt	% Change in Govt
Uttar Pradesh	-5,509,233	-11.68%	-4,254,948	-15.13%	-1,254,217	-6.58%
Bihar	-2,928,994	-10.66%	-1,229,824	-22.43%	-1,698,868	-7.73%
Maharashtra	-1,436,629	-6.36%	-959,882	-5.74%	-475,866	-8.13%
West Bengal	-976,809	-5.21%	-272,828	-12.58%	-703,885	-4.25%
Madhya Pradesh	-927,585	-5.74%	-449,290	-6.67%	-478,477	-5.07%
Jharkhand	-761,489	-9.55%	-415,872	-15.25%	-345,908	-6.60%

Total enrolment slipped from 26.5 Crores to 25.2 crores. The steepest drops have occurred in India's most populous states: Uttar Pradesh lost 55 lakh students (12%), while Bihar's rolls shortened by 29 lakh (11%). Other states have also witnessed notable declines. Maharashtra saw a decrease of 14.4 lakh students (6%), while West Bengal experienced a drop of 9.77 lakh students (5%). Madhya Pradesh and Jharkhand both faced declines of 7.6 lakh students (10%), further highlighting the widespread nature of the enrolment downturn. Despite the significant overall enrolment decline of 55 lakh students in Uttar Pradesh, government schools saw a decrease of 12.5 lakh students. The rest, 42 lakh, of the decline is in private aided, unaided, and other schools.

⁷ "OTHERS" in Table 1, Table 2 and Table 8 refers to the total number of schools, excluding Government Schools, which is equal to Private Aided + Private Unaided + Unrecognised Schools.

State/UT	Change in TOTAL	% Change in TOTAL	Change in OTHERS	% Change in OTHERS	Change in Govt	% Change in Govt
Andhra Pradesh	377,545	4.58%	854,051	24.07%	-476,450	-10.15%
Karnataka	306,273	2.53%	498,952	7.51%	-193,099	-3.55%
Telangana	111,845	1.62%	450,114	12.46%	-337,980	-10.23%
Odisha	73,032	0.96%	144,641	6.23%	-71,744	-1.37%
Delhi	56,407	1.23%	202,796	11.42%	-146,471	-5.24%
Tamil Nadu	49,159	0.38%	393,570	5.24%	-344,145	-6.48%

The decline in government school enrolment in 36 out of 36 States or UTs in India. Yet, the picture is not uniformly grim for all schools. Several States/UTs, including Andhra Pradesh (3.8 lakh, 5%), Karnataka (3.06 lakh, 3%), and Telangana (1.1 lakh, 2%), have seen enrolment growth. However, this increase, totaling nearly 8 lakh students, is largely driven by private and non-government schools, filling the gap left by declining government school enrolments.

TRENDS IN ENROLMENT BY LEVELS OF EDUCATION

Primary education enrolment has witnessed a significant drop over the past year. From 46.08% in 2021-22, the enrolment rate decreased to 44.75% in 2022-23. This decline is indicative of the challenges faced at the grassroots level of education. While the numbers for upper primary, secondary, and higher secondary education have shown modest increases, the primary level shows a worrying trend.

State/UT	Change in Number of Primary Enrolment
Uttar Pradesh	-3,998,638
Bihar	-1,501,836
West Bengal	-704,869
Madhya Pradesh	-582,089
Maharashtra	-509,007

Uttar Pradesh has seen the largest drop, with a 17% decrease in primary enrolment, resulting in a loss of nearly 40 lakh students. Bihar follows with a 11% reduction, equating

to a loss of 15 lakh students. Jharkhand also reported a significant drop, with 18% fewer students enrolled, amounting to a loss of 1 lakh students. Arunachal Pradesh experienced an 11% decline, reducing the primary enrolment by 17,590 students.

Table 4: Only 3 States/UTs with Primary Enrolment Increases, 2021-22 to 2022-23	
State/UT	Change in Number of Primary Enrolment
Gujarat	46,771
Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu	1,665
Delhi	815

In contrast, Gujarat, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, and Delhi are the only ones that reported increases in primary enrolment. Gujarat alone contributed 46,711 of the total 49,251 increase across these states. While the primary education sector faces challenges, other educational levels show slight increases, observed in upper primary (25.2% to 25.3%), secondary (14.7% to 15.1%), and higher secondary enrolment (10.2% to 10.4%).

Table 6: Top 7 States/UTs with Higher Secondary Enrolment Declines, 2021-22 to 2022-23	
State/UT	Change in Number of Higher Secondary Enrolment
Bihar	-350090
Uttar Pradesh	-212206
Rajasthan	-143827
Madhya Pradesh	-132718
Jharkhand	-132326
Maharashtra	-129760
Chhattisgarh	-94051

However, the higher secondary education sector paints a more complex picture. Uttar Pradesh, for instance, has seen a 14% increase in higher secondary institutions, adding 2,849 schools. Despite this, enrolment in higher secondary education has decreased by 4%, resulting in a loss of 2 lakh students. Bihar is also experiencing a decline, with an 11% decrease in higher secondary enrolment, equating to a loss of 3 lakh students. Other states that have reported significant losses in higher secondary enrolment include Maharashtra (-1.2 lakh students), Jharkhand (-1.3 lakh students), Madhya Pradesh (-1.3 lakh students), Rajasthan (-1.4 lakh students), and Chhattisgarh (-94,051 students).

Table 7: Top 7 States/UTs with Higher Secondary Enrolment Increases, 2021-22 to 2022-23

State/UT	Change in Number of Higher Secondary Enrolment
Odisha	147412
West Bengal	138453
Karnataka	138373
Telangana	107851
Delhi	31135
Andhra Pradesh	26318
Gujarat	15301

On the other hand, some states have seen increases in higher secondary enrolment. Karnataka shows a percentage increase with a 12% rise, adding 1.3 lakh students. Odisha also sees a 21.4% increase, contributing 1.4 lakh students. Telangana also recorded an impressive 13% increase, with 1 lakh more students enrolled. Other states showing growth include West Bengal (1.3 lakh students), Delhi (31,135 students), Andhra Pradesh (26,318 students), and Gujarat (15,301 students).

CONCLUSION

Overall, India's educational system is in a period of transition. While dropping school enrolment is noteworthy, there is a growth in private schools and expansion of schools up to higher secondary levels, with regional variations guiding their trend.

We await the release of detailed microdata school-wise, grade-wise, and gender-wise, as was done for the years up to 2021-22. While broad trends provide valuable insights, more detailed data would allow for a deeper understanding of regional variations and specific challenges, leading to targeted interventions for improved learning outcomes for 25 crore+ of our school-going children.

ANNEXURE

1. Total enrolment data has been provided on UDISE+ portal, from which the number of government enrolments for each state has been calculated by multiplying the total enrolment by the percentage of government enrolment.

For example, in Bihar, the total enrolment is 24,543,698, and the percentage of government enrolment is 82.67%. The number of government enrolments in Bihar is calculated as follows:

Government enrolment = Total enrolment × Percentage of government enrolment

Government enrolment = 24,543,698 × 82.67% = 20,290,275

2. This calculation method is applied to each state to determine the number of government enrolments and, by subtracting it from the total, to calculate others' enrolment:

OTHERS (Non-Government) Enrolment = Total Enrolment – Government Enrolment

Table 8: Enrolment Shifts in States and UTs from 2021-22 to 2022-23

State/UT	Change in TOTAL ENROLMENT 2022-23	Change % of TOTAL ENROLMENT 2022-23	Change in OTHERS ENROLMENT	Change % of OTHERS ENROLMENT	Change in Govt ENROLMENT 2022-23	Change % of Govt ENROLMENT 2022-23
Andhra Pradesh	377,545	4.58%	854,051	24.07%	-476,450	-10.15%
Karnataka	306,273	2.53%	498,952	7.51%	-193,099	-3.55%
Telangana	111,845	1.62%	450,114	12.46%	-337,980	-10.23%
Odisha	73,032	0.96%	144,641	6.23%	-71,744	-1.37%
Delhi	56,407	1.23%	202,796	11.42%	-146,471	-5.24%
Tamil Nadu	49,159	0.38%	393,570	5.24%	-344,145	-6.48%
Rajasthan	39,652	0.22%	793,788	10.24%	-753,329	-7.60%
Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu	6,609	4.96%	6,670	15.76%	-66	-0.07%
Goa	4,612	1.51%	10,300	3.93%	-5,697	-13.27%
Chandigarh	1,683	0.63%	12,032	11.63%	-10,345	-6.26%
Andaman & Nicobar Islands	1,246	1.69%	4,158	18.32%	-2,915	-5.70%
Ladakh	-947	-1.58%	1,987	6.52%	-2,936	-10.01%
Lakshadweep	-999	-7.35%	464	#DIV/0!	-1,463	-10.77%
Puducherry	-4,065	-1.59%	8,579	5.42%	-12,639	-12.98%
Sikkim	-7,759	-5.71%	-463	-0.90%	-7,291	-8.64%
Mizoram	-16,701	-5.39%	-5,033	-3.02%	-11,653	-8.13%
Himachal Pradesh	-17,634	-1.23%	34,321	6.40%	-51,931	-5.77%
Tripura	-19,323	-2.71%	9,402	5.50%	-28,725	-5.29%
Nagaland	-28,141	-6.34%	-9,096	-3.32%	-19,066	-11.20%
Arunachal Pradesh	-29,364	-8.29%	15,059	12.50%	-44,407	-18.99%
Manipur	-37,574	-5.42%	-17,690	-3.71%	-19,872	-9.17%
Gujarat	-42,696	-0.37%	73,928	1.24%	-116,052	-2.08%
Uttarakhand	-92,722	-3.78%	-3,880	-0.26%	-88,739	-9.05%
Meghalaya	-94,754	-8.10%	-47,401	-6.85%	-47,367	-9.93%
Jammu & Kashmir	-104,309	-3.84%	-49,741	-3.99%	-54,434	-3.69%
Chhattisgarh	-227,987	-3.80%	3,154	0.18%	-231,338	-5.43%
Punjab	-232,277	-3.78%	21,810	0.71%	-253,999	-8.22%
Kerala	-237,760	-3.70%	-169,494	-3.72%	-68,308	-3.67%
Haryana	-308,360	-5.11%	-122,805	-3.58%	-185,656	-7.13%
Assam	-428,060	-5.67%	-234,702	-10.35%	-193,386	-3.66%
Jharkhand	-761,489	-9.55%	-415,872	-15.25%	-345,908	-6.60%
Madhya Pradesh	-927,585	-5.74%	-449,290	-6.67%	-478,477	-5.07%
West Bengal	-976,809	-5.21%	-272,828	-12.58%	-703,885	-4.25%
Maharashtra	-1,436,629	-6.36%	-959,882	-5.74%	-475,866	-8.13%
Bihar	-2,928,994	-10.66%	-1,229,824	-22.43%	-1,698,868	-7.73%
Uttar Pradesh	-5,509,233	-11.68%	-4,254,948	-15.13%	-1,254,217	-6.58%

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